SCHEME OF WORK

Week	Topic
1	Revision of Last Term's Work and Exams; Summary: Death and the King's Horseman
2	Structure: Clauses; Writing: Speech Writing; Comprehension: The Lion and the Jewel; Vocabulary Development: Latin Expressions
3	Structure: Direct and Indirect Speech; Speech Work: Contrastive Stress; Comprehension: Meteors; Vocabulary Development: Astronomy
4	Comprehension: A Railway Journey; Writing: Formal and Informal Letters; Structure: Nominalization of Infinitives; Structure: Restrictive and Non-restrictive Clauses; Writing: Hints on Writing Essays
6	Speech Work: Learning the Requirement of the Examination on Orals; Structure: Hints on Lexis and Structure; Comprehension: Hints on Answering Comprehension Questions
7	Speech Work: Reviewing the Vowels and Consonants; Structure: Review of Tenses; Comprehension: Further Hints on How to Answer Comprehension Questions
8	Revision

COURSE CONTENT

WEEK 1

TOPICS: REVISION OF LAST TERM'S WORK; SUMMARY: DEATH AND THE KING'S HORSEMAN

Summary: Death and the King's Horseman

- The passage is an extract from the play 'Death and the King's Horseman'.
- In this passage, Elesin had just been prevented from committing suicide as the tradition demands.
- Elesin was supposed to take his life in order to join the king in the world of the ancestors.
- Simon Pilkings, the District Officer, intervened to stop the suicide and save Elesin's life.

WEEK 2

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: CLAUSES; WRITING: SPEECH WRITING; COMPREHENSION: THE LION AND THE JEWEL; VOCABULARY: LATIN EXPRESSIONS

Structure: Clauses

A clause is a group of words with a finite verb. A clause should have a subject and a predicate (e.g., *Idowu bought a piece of land.* Subject: Idowu. Predicate: bought a piece of land).

Types of Clauses

- **Independent clauses:** These are also called main or principal clauses. An independent clause expresses a complete thought and can stand on its own as a sentence (e.g., *My English master is a kind man.*).
- **Dependent Clauses:** These are also called subordinate clauses. A dependent clause does not express a complete thought and cannot stand on its own as a sentence. It depends on an independent clause for its meaning (e.g., *which he recommended.*).

Types of Subordinate Clauses

- **Noun Clauses:** A subordinate clause that has a noun as the head word and performs the functions of a noun. It is usually introduced by 'what' and 'that', and answers the question 'what or who?'.
  - *Subject of a sentence:* What he said is bitter.
  - *Object of a sentence:* He told us that he would come.
  - *Complement of subject:* Honesty is what we want.
  - *Complement of object:* We call him what he likes.
  - *Complement of a preposition:* The prize will go to whoever wins.
- **Adjectival Clauses:** A subordinate clause that performs the functions of an adjective, introduced by who, whom, whose, that, which, etc.
  - The man *who came here* is a teacher.
  - That is the goat *that ate our yam*.
  - The lady *whose car was stolen* is crying.

  - She has visited the place *where he was born*.
- **Adverbial Clauses:** A subordinate clause that performs the functions of an adverb. It modifies the verb in the main clause.
  - *Time:* Ada saw him *when she came to his office*.
  - *Place:* He left the letter *where it could be easily seen*.
  - *Manner:* The lady is treating us *as if we were her servants*.
  - *Reason: Because he was wrong*, he apologized.
  - *Purpose:* The athlete trained very hard *so that he might win the race*.
  - *Result:* Sule ate so much food at the party *that he started vomiting*.
  - *Comparison:* Amadi drank more wine *than I did*.
  - *Condition:* We shall attend his party *if he invites us*.
  - *Concession: Although Okorie is poor*, he is well respected.

Writing: Speech Writing

Characteristics of a Written Speech:

- **Formal Salutation (Vocatives):** There is always an audience to be addressed. Recognize and accord due respect to those at the high table and other dignitaries present.
- **Use of Personal Pronouns:** The speaker often personalizes the speech using pronouns like I, you, we, he, etc.
- **Use of Short Forms:** Speeches often utilize short forms of words (e.g., I'm, can't, don't) to reflect actual speech.
- **Introducing the Topic:** Introduce the topic in an interesting manner, showing competence and respect for the audience.
- **Developing the Topic:** Ensure logical sequencing of ideas and coherent presentation.
- **Concluding the Speech:** Round off neatly to reflect the entire speech.

Sample Outline: A Farewell Speech

- **Heading:** A FAREWELL SPEECH BY JOHNSON OJO DURING THE GRADUATION CEREMONY OF THE SS 3 STUDENTS IN THE SCHOOL HALL ON 30TH JULY, 2010.
- **Vocatives:** The Honourable Commissioner of Education, Our Dear Parents, The Principal, Our Teachers, Worthy Graduating Students, Fellow Students.

- **Paragraph 1:** Appreciate the privilege of speaking, explain the ceremony's importance, state your purpose.
- **Paragraph 2:** Commend the graduating students for their rigorous years in SSS.
- **Paragraph 3:** Remind them of the lessons of hard work, determination, and uprightness.
- **Paragraph 4:** Inform them of future hurdles (JAMB exams, campus life, dangers of liberty).
- **Paragraph 5:** Counsel them on choosing the path of high achievement.
- **Paragraph 6:** Conclude by thanking the audience and parents, wishing the students success, and wishing a safe journey.

Comprehension: Drama (The Lion and the Jewel)

- The passage is an extract from the play by Wole Soyinka titled 'The Lion and the Jewel'.
- Teacher Lakunle meets with Sidi on her way from the stream. She had a pot of water on her head, leading to a discussion.
- The teacher strongly opposes the idea of a young girl carrying a pot of water on her head and airs his views to Sidi.

Vocabulary Development: Latin Expressions Used in English

- **ad hoc:** Intended for a particular purpose
- **ad infinitum:** For ever
- **ad nauseam:** To the point of making one sick
- **bona fide:** Genuine
- **Curriculum vitae:** A summary of a person’s qualifications and career, used for job applications.
- **De facto:** In practice
- **De jure:** By right
- **Et cetera:** And the rest
- **Exempli gratia:** For the sake of an example (abbreviated to e.g.)
- **ex officio:** By the virtue of one’s position
- **Id est:** That is (abbreviated to i.e.)
- **impromptu:** Unprepared

- **in extremis:** In extreme conditions
- **persona non grata:** An unwelcome person
- **ultra vires:** Beyond one’s powers (when an authority does something they are not allowed to do).

WEEK 3

TOPICS: DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH; SPEECH WORK: CONTRASTIVE STRESS; VOCABULARY: ASTRONOMY

Structure: Direct and Indirect Speech

Direct Speech: Quoting the actual utterance of another speaker or writer. This is usually indicated by the use of opening and closing quotation marks.

- **Examples:**
  - Obioma said, ‘I will return next month, by the grace of God.’
  - According to Achebe, ‘Proverbs are the palm oil with which the Igbo eat their words.’
- **Features:** Enclosed in inverted commas, usually followed by a reporting verb (e.g., 'she said'), preceded by a comma or colon, and begins with a capital letter.

Indirect Speech: Reports what a speaker or writer has said without using their exact words.

- **Examples:**
  - Obioma said that he would return the following month by the grace of God.
  - Achebe said that proverbs are the palm oil with which the Igbo eat their words.
- **Features:**
  - Quotation marks are not used.
  - If the reporting verb is in the past, the verb in the reported speech changes to the past tense.
  - If the reporting verb is in the present or future, the verb in the reported speech does not change.
  - If what is expressed is a universal truth, no changes take place in the reported speech's tense.

Speech Work: Contrastive Stress

The stressing of a particular word more than other words in a sentence is referred to as emphatic or contrastive stress. This stress affects the meaning of the sentence.

- **JAMES** borrowed the novel. (i.e. James, not anybody else, borrowed it).

- James **BORROWED** the novel. (i.e. James didn't steal or buy the novel, he borrowed it).
- I **BOUGHT** the book. (I didn't steal it).
- This is **THE** Mr. Obi. (Of special fame).

Vocabulary Development: Astronomy

Astronomy is the scientific study of the universe, especially of the motions, positions, sizes, composition, and behaviour of astronomical objects.

- **Universe:** The totality of all matter and energy that exists in the vastness of space.
- **Planet:** An astronomical object that orbits a star and does not shine with its own light.
- **Stars:** An astronomical object usually visible as a small bright point of light in the sky.
- **Orbit:** A single revolution of an astronomical object around a larger astronomical object.
- **Cosmonaut:** An astronaut in the space programmes of Russia and the former Soviet Union.
- **Galaxies:** A group of billions of stars and their planets, gas, and dust.
- **Eclipse:** The partial or complete hiding from view of an astronomical object.
- **Astronaut:** Someone trained to travel and perform tasks in space.
- **Gravity:** The attraction due to gravitation that the Earth or another astronomical object exerts on an object.

WEEK 4

TOPICS: WRITING: FORMAL AND INFORMAL LETTERS; STRUCTURE: NOMINALIZATION AND RESTRICTIVE CLAUSES; WRITING HINTS

Writing: Formal and Informal Letters

Formal Letters: Written to people in their official positions.

- **Features:**
  - Writer's Address and Date (top right-hand corner).
  - Receiver's Address (left-hand corner beneath the writer's address).
  - Salutation (Dear Sir or Dear Madam).
  - Heading / Topic / Title (written below the salutation).
  - Introduction (straightforward and precise).
  - Body of the letter (at least three well-developed paragraphs).
  - Conclusion (done in one paragraph).
  - Subscript / Complimentary close ('Yours faithfully,' followed by signature and full name).

Informal Letters: Written to people who are very familiar to us.

- **Features:** Writer's Address and Date, Salutation, Introduction, Body of the letter, Subscript (Complimentary close).

Structure: Nominalization of Infinitives

Nominalization is the changing of a part of speech into a noun by the addition of a suffix.

- Advise -> Advice
- Apologise -> Apology
- Authorise -> Authority
- Choose -> Choice
- Fail -> Failure
- Fix -> Fixture
- Hate -> Hatred

- Enjoy -> Enjoyment
- Know -> Knowledge
- Live -> Life
- Oppose -> Opposition
- Obey -> Obedience
- Secure -> Security
- Rob -> Robbery
- See -> Sight
- Speak -> Speech
- Serve -> Service
- Think -> Thought
- Strike -> Stroke
- Weigh -> Weight

Structure: Restrictive and Non-Restrictive Clauses

- **Non-Restrictive Clause:** Provides additional, non-essential information to the subject and is marked with commas.
  - The young lawyer, *who is 25*, gave the closing remark.
  - The house, *which has been renovated*, looks very new.
  - The principal, *who I told you about*, is a sadist.

Writing: Hints on Writing Essays in the Examination

- Treat as many ideas in relation to the topics as can be discussed within the time allowed.
- Present ideas in a new perspective and in an orderly manner.
- Language should be appropriate and clear to the reader.
- Place due emphasis on correctness of language.
- Avoid bias or overzealousness.
- Keep within the time allocated for the essay.

WEEK 6

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: REQUIREMENT OF EXAMINATIONS; STRUCTURE: HINTS ON LEXIS; COMPREHENSION HINTS

Speech Work: Requirement of the Examination on Orals

- **Vowels:** There are twenty vowels in the English language (twelve pure vowels and eight diphthongs).
- **Consonants:** There are twenty-four consonants, classified by place of articulation, manner of articulation, and state of the glottis.
- **Word-stress:** Refers to the amount of pressure exerted when pronouncing a particular syllable of a word (marked with a slash in dictionaries).
- **Emphatic Stress:** Stressing a particular word more than other words in a sentence, altering its implied meaning.
- **Rhymes:** Occurs when two or more words have a similar sound at the end.

Structure: Hints on Lexis and Structure

- **Lexis:** Refers to the vocabulary or the entire stock of words in a language. Examinations test the scope of a candidate's vocabulary and skills to use appropriate words in context.
- **Structure:** How words combine to form larger units.
- **Register:** A list of words, expressions, or terms regularly used in relation to a particular subject-matter or human activity.

Comprehension: Hints on Answering Comprehension Questions

- Read the passage carefully and quickly to get what it is all about.
- Read the questions that follow it.
- Read the passage all over again, jotting down points that will help answer the questions.
- Write out your answers in clear, correct English.
- Read over your answers to ensure there are no mistakes.
- **Crucial Rules:**

- Obey instructions to the letter (e.g., if a one-word answer is required, do not write a sentence).
- Do not give unrequired information.
- Never give two answers where one is demanded.
- When replacing a word, test your equivalent in the passage to ensure original grammatical meaning is retained.

WEEK 7

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: REVIEWING VOWELS AND CONSONANTS; STRUCTURE: REVIEW OF TENSES

Speech Work: Reviewing the Vowels and Consonants

Pure Vowels (12):

- /iː/ (Seat, Cheap, Sheep)
- /i/ (sit, chip, ship)
- /e/ (set, bread, friend)
- /æ/ (Sat, Chat, match)
- /aː/ (Far, pass, father)
- /ɔ/ (Dog, hot, what)
- /ɔː/ (port, Lord, ward)
- /u/ (full, pull, would)
- /uː/ (fool, pool, coup)
- /ʌ/ (fun, cut, tongue)
- /ɜː/ (first, nurse, word)
- /ə/ (again, away, forget)

Diphthongs (8):

- /ei/ (eight, gate, stable)
- /əv/ (go, boat, toe)
- /ai/ (bite, fight, die)
- /au/ (how, south, doubt)
- /ɔi/ (boy, oil, toy)
- /iə/ (fear, hear, cheer)
- /eə/ (fare, hair, bare)
- /uə/ (sure, poor, tour)

Consonants (24):

- /p/ (People, deep), /b/ (ball, debate), /t/ (take, mistake), /d/ (do, admit)
- /k/ (can, kettle), /g/ (gun, bag)
- /tʃ/ (church, watch), /dʒ/ (judge, joy, bridge)
- /f/ (fever, safe), /v/ (voice, revise), /θ/ (thank, both), /ð/ (that, mother)
- /s/ (sun, miss), /z/ (zoo, wise), /ʃ/ (shirt, wish), /ʒ/ (measure, pleasure)
- /h/ (house, hurry)
- /m/ (man, remember), /n/ (name, renew), /ŋ/ (going, doing)
- /l/ (late, little), /r/ (write, rat)
- /w/ (worry, reward), /j/ (yam, yes)

Structure: Review of Tenses

Tense occurs only in verbs and refers to the changes that take place in the form of the verb to indicate time. Only two tenses, the present and the past, can be strictly identified morphologically in English.

- **The Present Tense:** The only change that takes place occurs when the verb agrees with a third-person singular subject (e.g., He *sleeps*, wakes and eats vs. They *sleep*, wake and eat).
- **The Past Tense:** Regular verbs form their past by adding 'ed' (e.g., *worked*). Irregular verbs form their past tense in different ways (e.g., *spoke*).